Table 16 Modification of Diet For Elderly

Dietary modifications	Reasons
Foods must be soft and easily chewable	Problems of dentition -fallen teeth or dentures
Foods should be easily digestible	Decreased production of digestive enzymes
Restricted fat in diet, inclusion of Poly unsaturated fatty acid (PUFA)	Susceptible to heart diseases
Foods rich in fibre should be given	To prevent constipation, reduce cholesterol levels. Also to prevent colon cancer
Coffee, tea, cold beverages should be restricted	May result in insomnia
Foods rich in calcium such as is milk should be given	To compensate bone loss and prevent osteoporosis
Green leafy vegetables can be given liberally	Source of nutrients like: iron riboflavin, folic acid, vitamin c, antioxidants, carotene, and fibre
Familiar foods should be included (others difficult to digest) New foods are difficult to accept	Unfamiliar or changes in the food pattern- may lead to Psychological problems-depression and anxiety
Clear soup can be given at the beginning of the meal	Aids digestion
Small and frequent meals should be given instead of 3 heavy meals	Favours complete digestion, prevents distress
Glass of milk can be given before sleep	Induces sleep
Heavy meal-lunch Light meal-dinner	Sleep is less likely to be disturbed
Too many sweets with lots of fats and sugar should be avoided	Too much of sugar may cause fermentation, discomfort-due to indigestion and causes tooth ache and increases cholesterol level. May lead to obesity
Plenty of fluids	To prevent constipation and dehydration



Activity 6

Debate on the importance of vegetarian and non vegetarian diet

SUMMARY

1. An individual's needs for nutrients and energy change over the life span.
2. The need for nutrients increases during periods of growth such as infancy, adolescence and during pregnancy.
3. When the growth period declines, energy needs and the need for certain nutrients declines.
4. Nutrition for children and teens should focus on a balanced diet, with activity levels factored in, whereas in adults, both young and old, it is imperative to focus on preventing diet-related health problems.
5. Healthy dietary practices and habits and regular physical activity can help reduce

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